Neon Blade: Game Design Document

Weeks 8–9 · Mobile UI + Pre-production

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Repository: neon-blade-mobile
Engine: Unity 6 (uGUI)
Platform: Android (landscape)

1. Concept

Neon Blade is a 2D neon-noir action platformer inspired by Katana Zero. The player controls a lone swordsman who clears short rooms full of enemies. Every hit is lethal: one strike kills an enemy, and one hit kills the player. Rooms restart instantly after death, so the game is about planning an attack, executing it precisely and trying again.

game pitch: "One hit, one kill"

2. Genre and Target Audience

- **Genre:** 2D action platformer, one-hit-kill, room-based puzzle combat.
- **Platform:** Android phones, landscape orientation.
- **Audience:** Players aged 14+ who enjoy short, challenging, replayable levels (fans of Katana Zero, Hotline Miami, Super Meat Boy).
- **Session length:** 1–3 minutes per room, 10–15 minutes per play session.

3. Core Loop

1. Enter a room and observe the enemy positions.
2. Plan the route and choose when to dash and strike.
3. Execute: move, jump and dash-attack through enemies.
4. If the player is hit, they die and the room restarts instantly.
5. When all enemies are defeated, the exit opens and the player moves to the next room.

The loop is intentionally short so that failure costs only a few seconds and motivates another attempt.

4. Controls (Mobile, Landscape)

Control	Position	Action
Left / Right buttons	Bottom-left	Move the hero horizontally
Jump button	Bottom-right	Jump
Attack button	Bottom-right	Dash-strike in the facing direction
Pause button	Top-left	Pause the game and open the pause menu

The layout keeps both thumbs at the screen edges, leaving the center of the screen free for gameplay. Buttons are large (140–160 px on the 1920×1080 reference) for comfortable touch input.

5. UI Design (Mobile UI Implementation)

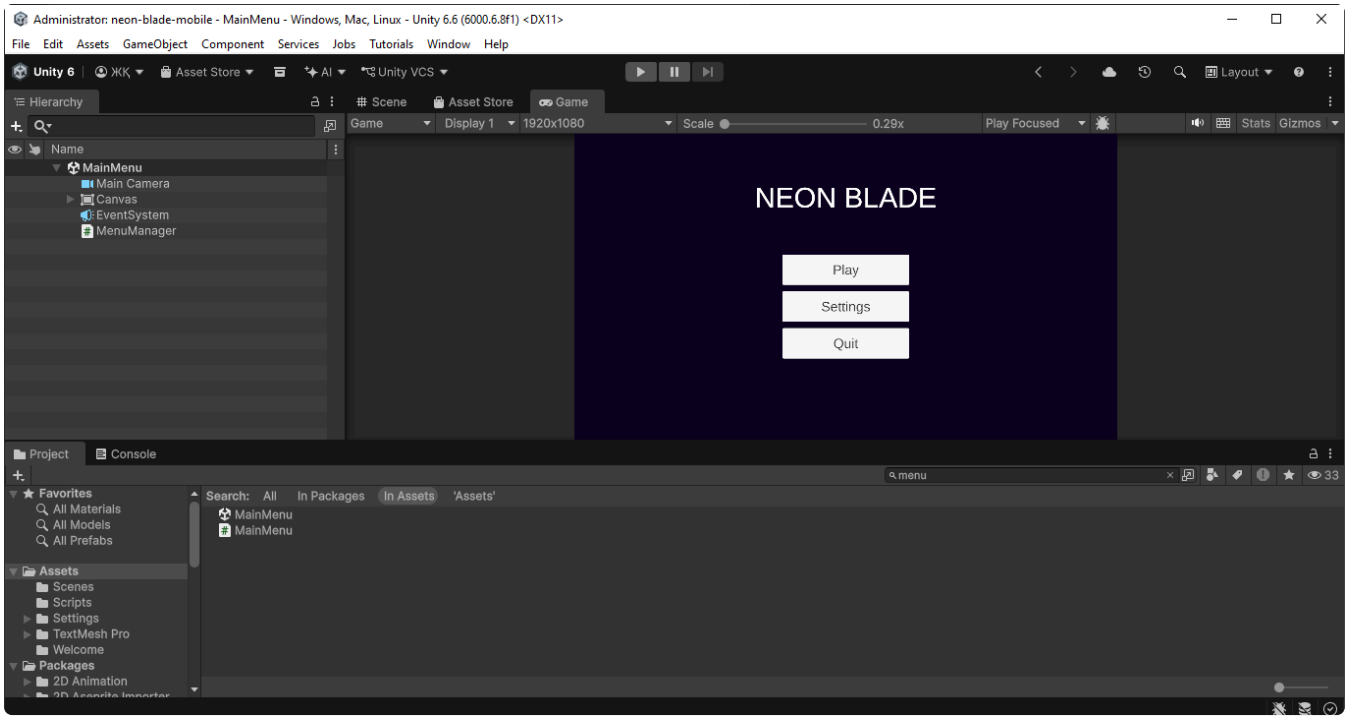
Canvas Scaler settings (all canvases): UI Scale Mode = Scale With Screen Size, Reference Resolution = 1920×1080, Match Width Or Height = 0.5.

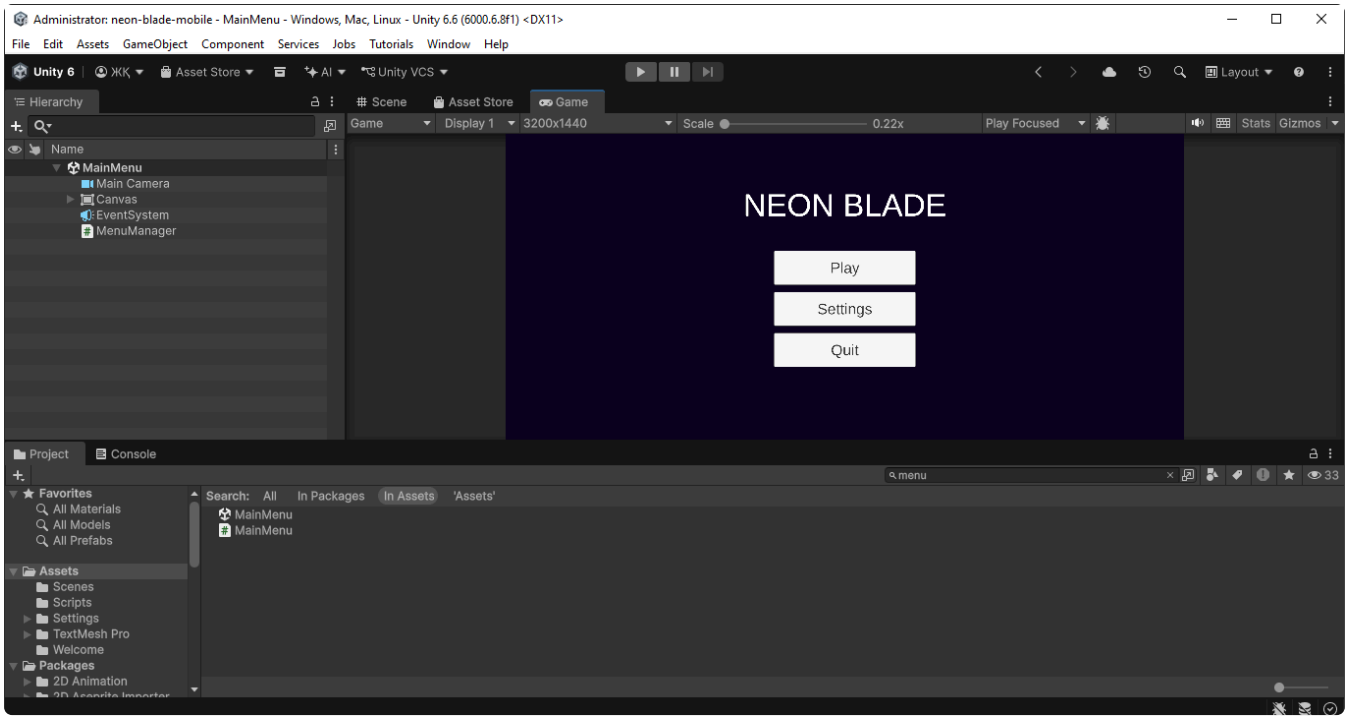
Main menu: a full-screen dark background stretched with stretch-stretch anchors, the game title anchored to the top-center, and Play, Settings and Quit buttons anchored to the middle-center.

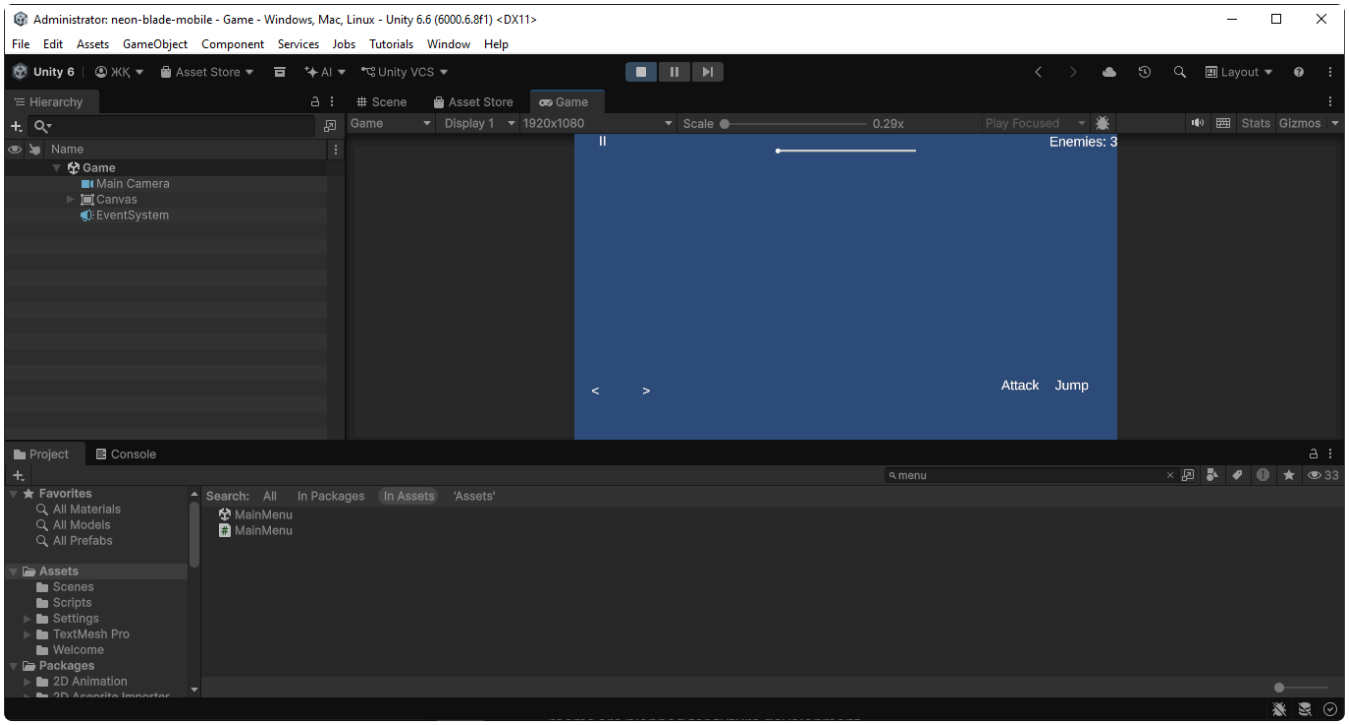
HUD (in-game):

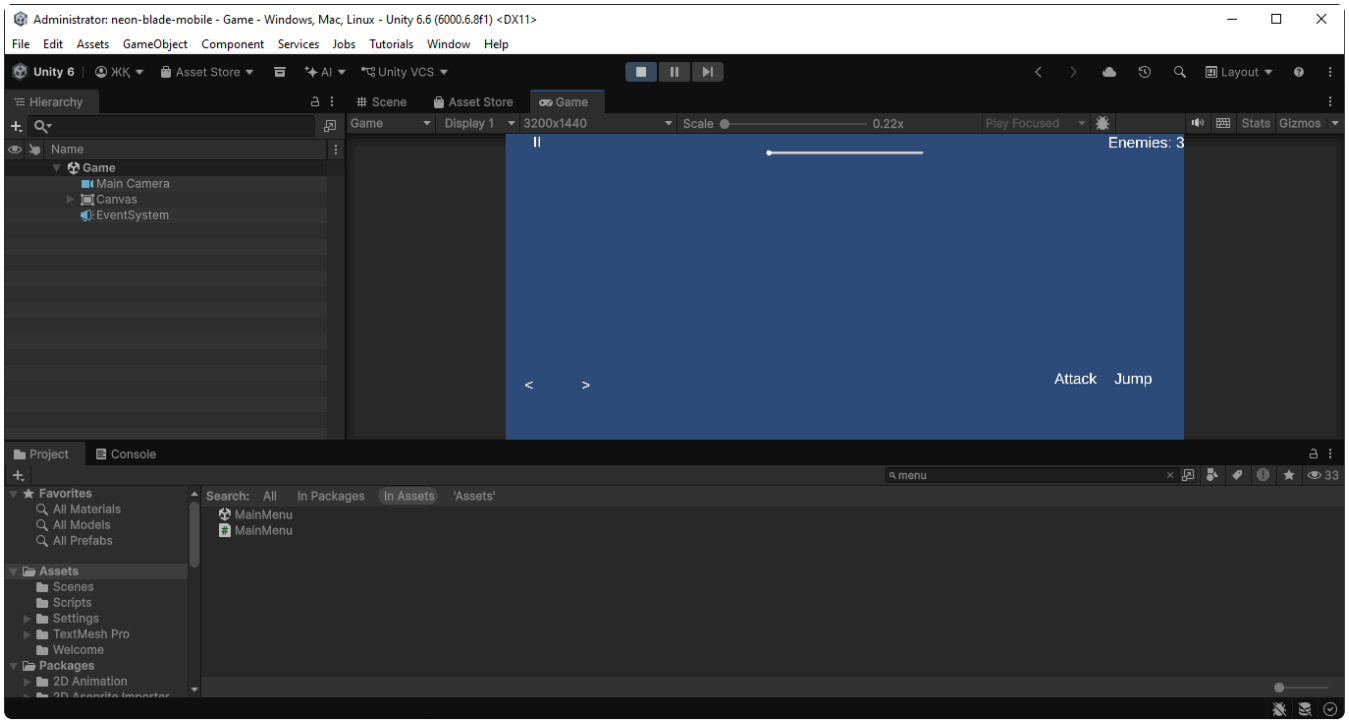
- Enemies-remaining counter anchored to the top-right (the room goal replaces a traditional score).
- Pause button anchored to the top-left.
- Slow-motion bar (slider) anchored to the top-center.
- Movement buttons anchored to the bottom-left; Jump and Attack buttons anchored to the bottom-right.
- All HUD elements are placed inside a SafeArea container so that notches and rounded corners do not hide controls.

Tested resolutions: Screenshots are submitted separately and show that all elements keep their corners on both screens.


Administrator: neon-blade-mobile - MainMenu - Windows, Mac, Linux - Unity 6.6 (6000.6.8f1) <DX11>
File Edit Assets GameObject Component Services Jobs Tutorials Window Help
Unity 6
Hierarchy
Scene
Asset Store
Game
Display 1
1920x1080
Scale
0.29x
Play Focused
Stats
Gizmos
Name
MainMenu
Main Camera
Canvas
EventSystem
MenuManager
NEON BLADE
Play
Settings
Quit
Project
Console
menu
Favorites
All Materials
All Models
All Prefabs
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Assets
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Scripts
Settings
TextMesh Pro
Welcome
Packages
2D Animation


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File Edit Assets GameObject Component Services Jobs Tutorials Window Help
Unity 6
Hierarchy
Scene
Asset Store
Game
Display 1
3200x1440
Scale
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Play Focused
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6. Levels

The full game plan has five short rooms with growing difficulty:

1. **Room 1: Training.** One stationary enemy; teaches movement, jump and attack.
2. **Room 2: Patrol.** Two enemies, one of which patrols back and forth.
3. **Room 3: Platforms.** Enemies placed on different heights; requires jump timing.
4. **Room 4: Traps.** Adds lasers and spikes that kill the player instantly.

5. **Room 5: Mini-challenge.** Several enemies and traps combined; uses the slow-motion mechanic.

Current prototype scope: main menu, in-game HUD and one test room. The remaining rooms are planned for future development.

7. Art Style

- **Visuals:** pixel art, dark noir backgrounds with neon accents.
- **Palette:** background `#0D0221`, neon pink `#FF2A6D`, neon cyan `#05D9E8`, white for text.
- **UI:** flat, high-contrast buttons with glowing outlines; large readable font.
- **Assets:** free pixel-art packs (Kenney.nl, itch.io) recolored to the palette.
- **References:** Katana Zero, Hotline Miami, synthwave aesthetics.
- **Audio (planned):** synthwave soundtrack, short sword and hit sound effects.

8. Team Roles

Role	Responsible
Programmer	Zhalgas
UI designer (Canvas, anchors)	Zhalgas
Game / level designer	Zhalgas
Artist (asset selection)	Zhalgas
GitHub and video	Zhalgas

The project is currently developed solo. Open to collaborators for art, sound and level design.

9. Technical Plan

- **Engine and language:** Unity 6, C#, uGUI with TextMeshPro.
- **Physics:** Rigidbody2D and Collider2D for the hero and enemies.
- **Scene structure:** MainMenu → Game (scene loading via SceneManager).
- **Version control:** GitHub repository, small commits with descriptive messages, Unity .gitignore.

10. Roadmap

Stage	Goal
Weeks 8–9	GDD, repository, main menu and HUD with Canvas Scaler and anchors
Next	Playable hero (move, jump, dash-strike), one enemy type, working enemy counter
Later	Slow-motion mechanic, more rooms, traps, sound and music
Stretch goals	Rewind replay on death, boss room, Settings menu with volume